

Taking No Chances on V-P

DELHI The United National Progressive Alliance (UNPA) arrived a little too late on the scene of the presidential elections. By the time it woke up, the UPA and NDA had already announced their respective presidential candidates. Choosing to abstain from voting was the best the alliance could do. It is, however, not taking any chances with the vice-presidential elections. The coalition of eight parties has now come up with Rasheed Masood of the Samajwadi Party (SP) as its nominee for the post.

The five times Lok Sabha member from Saharanpur in western Uttar Pradesh was born on August 15, 1947 and describes himself as an agriculturist. In his youth, Masood had closely worked with the late farmers' leader Charan



THE THIRD ACE: Masood Singh. "Masood's credentials are definitely better than those of Pratibha Patil," said SP General Secretary Amar Singh. Earlier this week, there were rumours that National Conference patron Farooq Abdullah would be their candidate.

While BJP is yet to make up its mind, a member of its national executive has begun dreaming about the job—former Rajya Sabha

chairperson Najma Heptullah, who was a member of the Congress in 2002 and had been then snubbed by her party for aspiring to be the vice-president. After joining BJP, she had harboured hopes of acquiring that office. With her name back in circulation now, Heptullah is elated.

The Left Front is a divided house over the vice-presidential polls which will be held on August 10. The CPI, RSP and Forward Bloc are angry with CPI(M) General Secretary Prakash Karat for saying that his party would prefer any person with an "exemplary record in some field".

Since all four Left parties had agreed on a person with a political background for the President's position, the CPI(M)'s decision of fielding someone who is not a member of any political party for the post of the V-P has them confused. Why, asked the smaller Left partners. Big brother CPI(M) is not telling.

by Satarupa Bhattacharjya

SIGNPOSTS

CHARGESHEETED: IPS officers **D.G. Vanzara** and 11 others in the Sohrabuddin Sheikh fake encounter case. The chargesheet, authored by CID Inspector General Geeta Johri, has accused them of staging a fake encounter for "personal glory" and awards.

FILED: A chargesheet against former BJP MP **Babubhai Katara** and five co-accused arrested in connection with the human trafficking case by the Crime Branch of Delhi Police.

WON: The men's singles title in ITF Futures tennis tournament, held in Morocco, by **Karan Rastogi**. He beat Spain's Cesar Ferrer-Victoria.



AWARDED: Tata Sons Chairman **Ratan Tata** honorary fellowship of the London

School of Economics and Political Science for his contribution to global industry.

VIS-A-VIS **MURLI MANOHAR JOSHI** former HRD minister **versus** **RENUKA CHOWDHURY** Women and Child Development Minister

The proposed **SEX** education modules are an encouragement rather than education about **SEX**.



SAURABH SINGH

Opposition to sex education is just moral hypocrisy and posturing on the part of those who are opposing it.

EPILOGUE: A section of the world's next superpower is still stuck with medieval attitudes.